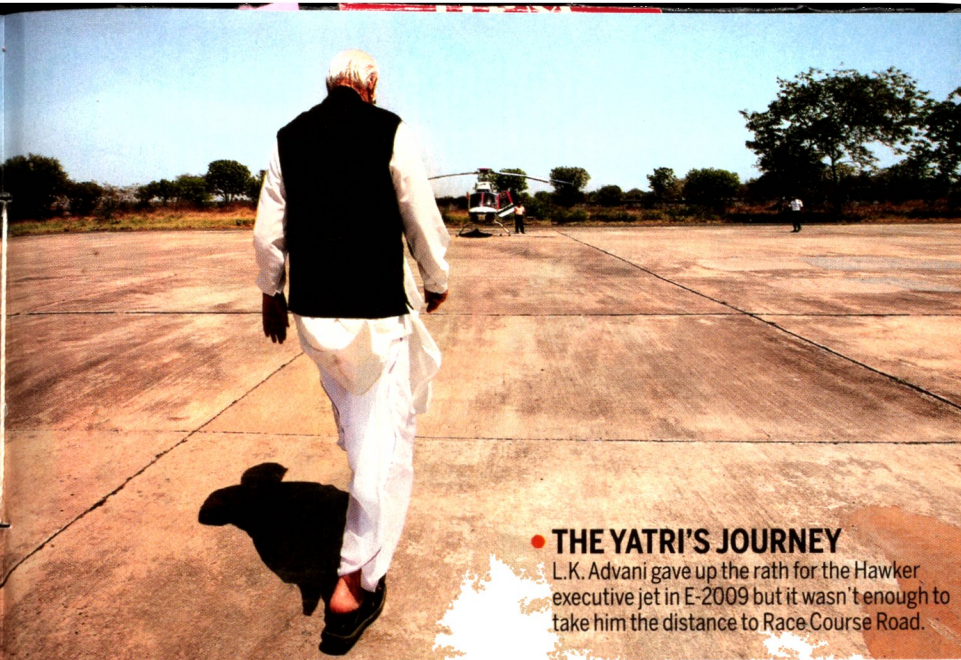




• THE YATRI'S JOURNEY

L.K. Advani gave up the rath for the Hawker executive jet in E-2009 but it wasn't enough to take him the distance to Race Course Road.

SUBIR HALDAR

BANERJEE SINGH



It was an election where words drowned work. Where backdoor deals seemed more important than ballot boxes. Where much-touted game-changers proved to be big-time losers. And where no one knew how it would all end, in tears or triumph. In the end though, the people of India voted over 30 days of sweltering heat for national stability, not coalition chemistry, and the mainstream, not the marginal.

• RETURN OF THE SINGH

For the Congress workers, written off by pundits and pollsters alike, the taste of victory was sweet. And its sound deafening.

The Drama QUEENS

- Abusing Nafisa Ali got Akhilesh Das 15 minutes on every news bulletin. Azam Khan brought tears to Jayaprada's eyes. Maneka Gandhi and Mayawati exchanged some harsh words on motherhood. Mamata Banerjee's slogan for 2004, now or never, finally came good.



PTI



AP



SUNIL K. MEHTA